THE COMFORT BOND™

# The Programming Blueprint™ Pro

Your Complete Quarterly Engagement System

Quarter 3 · July – September 2026

*Stop searching. Start planning.*

# Welcome to Your Quarterly Blueprint

You're holding a complete 13-week engagement planning system. Every theme, every coaching tip, and every resource connection in this document was designed for one purpose: to give you a framework so you never have to build a week from scratch again.

This isn't a list of activities. It's a decision-making structure that balances what your residents need across six dimensions of meaningful engagement — so your programming has variety, dignity, and purpose every single week.

## How to Use This in 5 Minutes

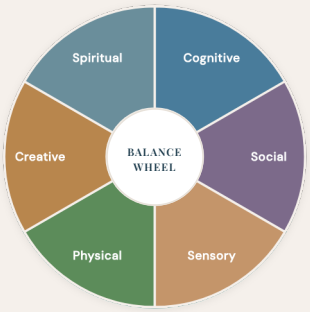
**Step 1** Start with the Quarterly Overview on page 4. Read the 13 themes to see the full arc of the quarter.

**Step 2** Each week, turn to that week's Planning Page. Fill in your community name, the dates, and your activities for each day.

**Step 3** Use the Theme Guide for that week to find conversation starters, coaching tips, and the dimension mapping.

**Step 4** Check the Resource Integration Guide to see which Comfort Bond™ kits align with each theme — or use the 'No Kit' alternative.

# The Engagement Balance Wheel




Six dimensions of meaningful engagement. Use this tracker to mark which you cover each week. If a dimension hasn't been touched in two weeks, that's your signal to adjust. The wheel is a compass, not a checklist.

- Cognitive (C)
- Social (So)
- Sensory (Se)
- Physical (P)
- Creative (Cr)
- Spiritual (Sp)

## QUARTERLY DIMENSION TRACKER

| Week | C | So | Se | P | Cr | Sp |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| Wk 1 | ○ | ○ | ○ | ○ | ○ | ○ |
| Wk 2 | ○ | ○ | ○ | ○ | ○ | ○ |
| Wk 3 | ○ | ○ | ○ | ○ | ○ | ○ |
| Wk 4 | ○ | ○ | ○ | ○ | ○ | ○ |
| Wk 5 | ○ | ○ | ○ | ○ | ○ | ○ |
| Wk 6 | ○ | ○ | ○ | ○ | ○ | ○ |
| Wk 7 | ○ | ○ | ○ | ○ | ○ | ○ |
| Wk 8 | ○ | ○ | ○ | ○ | ○ | ○ |
| Wk 9 | ○ | ○ | ○ | ○ | ○ | ○ |
| Wk 10 | ○ | ○ | ○ | ○ | ○ | ○ |
| Wk 11 | ○ | ○ | ○ | ○ | ○ | ○ |
| Wk 12 | ○ | ○ | ○ | ○ | ○ | ○ |
| Wk 13 | ○ | ○ | ○ | ○ | ○ | ○ |

# Quarterly Overview · Q3 2026

July – September · 13 Weeks at a Glance

| WK | THEME | DIMENSION | OBSERVANCE |
|---|---|---|---|
| 1 | Red, White, and Blue Memories | Social | *Independence Day (July 4)* |
| 2 | Summer Sounds | Sensory | *National Ice Cream Month* |
| 3 | Kitchen Table Memories | Cognitive | *National Mac & Cheese Day (Jul 14)* |
| 4 | The Great Outdoors | Physical | *National Parks Month* |
| 5 | County Fair Classics | Social | *Summer Fair Season* |
| 6 | The Sunday Drive | Cognitive | *Classic Car Week* |
| 7 | Main Street Memories | Creative | *National Hometown Month* |
| 8 | Porches, Stoops, and Screen Doors | Sensory | *Senior Citizens Day (Aug 21)* |
| 9 | Songs That Changed Everything | Spiritual | *Back to School Season* |
| 10 | The Schoolhouse | Cognitive | *Labor Day (Sep 7)* |
| 11 | Handy Work | Physical | *National Grandparents Day (Sep 13)* |
| 12 | Letters, Cards, and the Mailbox | Creative | *First Day of Fall (Sep 22)* |
| 13 | What I Know for Sure | Spiritual | *National Radio Day* |

# Week 1: Red, White, and Blue Memories

Community: Week of:

Social · Independence Day (July 4)

| DAY | MORNING | AFTERNOON | DIM. | NOTES |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| Monday | | | | |
| Tuesday | | | | |
| Wednesday | | | | |
| Thursday | | | | |
| Friday | | | | |
| Saturday | | | | |
| Sunday | | | | |

**COACHING TIP**

► Open with a sensory anchor, not a question. Play ten seconds of a marching band or the pop of fireworks before you say a word. Let the room react first — the sounds prime the memory faster than any prompt you can read aloud.

Highlight moment this week:

# Week 2: Summer Sounds

Community: _____ Week of: _____

Sensory · National Ice Cream Month

| DAY | MORNING | AFTERNOON | DIM. | NOTES |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| Monday | | | | |
| Tuesday | | | | |
| Wednesday | | | | |
| Thursday | | | | |
| Friday | | | | |
| Saturday | | | | |
| Sunday | | | | |

**COACHING TIP**

► Bring the sounds into the room. A 30-second recording of crickets, a screen door closing, or an ice cream truck jingle played from your phone before the session starts will do more to unlock memory than any question you ask. Let residents identify the sound first — that moment of recognition is where the engagement begins.

Highlight moment this week: _____

# Week 3: Kitchen Table Memories

Community: Week of:

Cognitive · National Mac & Cheese Day (Jul 14)

| DAY | MORNING | AFTERNOON | DIM. | NOTES |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| Monday | | | | |
| Tuesday | | | | |
| Wednesday | | | | |
| Thursday | | | | |
| Friday | | | | |
| Saturday | | | | |
| Sunday | | | | |

**COACHING TIP**

► Start with objects, not stories. Ask “What was always on your kitchen table?” before you ask about meals or memories. Concrete objects — a tablecloth pattern, a sugar bowl, a crocheted centerpiece — are easier to recall than events, and they open the door to everything else.

Highlight moment this week:

# Week 4: The Great Outdoors

Community: _____ Week of: _____

Physical · National Parks Month

| DAY | MORNING | AFTERNOON | DIM. | NOTES |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| Monday | | | | |
| Tuesday | | | | |
| Wednesday | | | | |
| Thursday | | | | |
| Friday | | | | |
| Saturday | | | | |
| Sunday | | | | |

**COACHING TIP**

► If weather and mobility allow, hold this session outside or near an open window. Even a small change in setting — a breeze, the sound of birds, natural light on their faces — does more to activate outdoor memories than the best prompt you could write.

Highlight moment this week: _____

# Week 5: County Fair Classics

Community: _____ Week of: _____

Social · Summer Fair Season

| DAY | MORNING | AFTERNOON | DIM. | NOTES |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| Monday | | | | |
| Tuesday | | | | |
| Wednesday | | | | |
| Thursday | | | | |
| Friday | | | | |
| Saturday | | | | |
| Sunday | | | | |

**COACHING TIP**

► Food is the fastest entry point for this theme. Before you ask a single question, say: "Raise your hand if you can still taste a corn dog from the county fair." The laughter and the hand-raising breaks the ice instantly. Follow the food memories — they lead everywhere else.

Highlight moment this week: _____

# Week 6: The Sunday Drive

Community: _____ Week of: _____

Cognitive · Classic Car Week

| DAY | MORNING | AFTERNOON | DIM. | NOTES |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| Monday | | | | |
| Tuesday | | | | |
| Wednesday | | | | |
| Thursday | | | | |
| Friday | | | | |
| Saturday | | | | |
| Sunday | | | | |

**COACHING TIP**

► Anchor this theme in the car itself, not the destination. Ask about bench seats, stick shifts, AM radios, and the sound of gravel under tires. The physical experience of being in a car from that era is something residents recall with remarkable clarity — and it makes the stories specific rather than generic.

Highlight moment this week: _____

# Week 7: Main Street Memories

Community: _____ Week of: _____

Creative · National Hometown Month

| DAY | MORNING | AFTERNOON | DIM. | NOTES |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| Monday | | | | |
| Tuesday | | | | |
| Wednesday | | | | |
| Thursday | | | | |
| Friday | | | | |
| Saturday | | | | |
| Sunday | | | | |

**COACHING TIP**

► Give each resident a blank index card and ask them to draw a simple map of their hometown Main Street from memory — just the shop names in order, nothing artistic. The act of mapping unlocks spatial memory, and residents will surprise themselves with how much they remember. Share the maps with the group afterward.

Highlight moment this week: _____

# Week 8: Porches, Stoops, and Screen Doors

Community: _____ Week of: _____

Sensory · Senior Citizens Day (Aug 21)

| DAY | MORNING | AFTERNOON | DIM. | NOTES |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| Monday | | | | |
| Tuesday | | | | |
| Wednesday | | | | |
| Thursday | | | | |
| Friday | | | | |
| Saturday | | | | |
| Sunday | | | | |

**COACHING TIP**

► Slow this session down. The porch was never rushed, and your facilitation shouldn't be either. Leave longer pauses between prompts than you normally would. Let residents sit with a memory for a moment before moving on. The quiet is part of the experience — it mirrors the pace of the porch itself.

Highlight moment this week: _____

# Week 9: Songs That Changed Everything

Community: _____ Week of: _____

Spiritual · Back to School Season

| DAY | MORNING | AFTERNOON | DIM. | NOTES |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| Monday | | | | |
| Tuesday | | | | |
| Wednesday | | | | |
| Thursday | | | | |
| Friday | | | | |
| Saturday | | | | |
| Sunday | | | | |

**COACHING TIP**

► Do not play full songs during this session — play only the first 10–15 seconds of each. The opening notes are the emotional trigger; the full track turns the session into a listening party. You want residents talking about what the song means to them, not sitting quietly while it plays out.

Highlight moment this week: _____

# Week 10: The Schoolhouse

Community: _____ Week of: _____

Cognitive · Labor Day (Sep 7)

| DAY | MORNING | AFTERNOON | DIM. | NOTES |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| Monday | | | | |
| Tuesday | | | | |
| Wednesday | | | | |
| Thursday | | | | |
| Friday | | | | |
| Saturday | | | | |
| Sunday | | | | |

**COACHING TIP**

► Write a simple math problem on a whiteboard before the session starts — something like "7 × 8 = ?" — and don't say a word about it. Residents will notice, someone will call out the answer, and the room will instantly shift into school mode. That moment of automatic recall — the multiplication table drilled into them sixty years ago — is the perfect warm-up.

Highlight moment this week: _____

# Week 11: Handy Work

Community: _____ Week of: _____

Physical · National Grandparents Day (Sep 13)

| DAY | MORNING | AFTERNOON | DIM. | NOTES |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| Monday | | | | |
| Tuesday | | | | |
| Wednesday | | | | |
| Thursday | | | | |
| Friday | | | | |
| Saturday | | | | |
| Sunday | | | | |

**COACHING TIP**

► Bring a physical object into the room — a wrench, a thimble, a hand plane, a crochet hook — and pass it around before you ask any questions. Let residents hold it. The weight and texture in their hands will activate motor memory and unlock stories about competence and capability that verbal prompts alone cannot reach.

Highlight moment this week: _____

# Week 12: Letters, Cards, and the Mailbox

Community: _____ Week of: _____

Creative · First Day of Fall (Sep 22)

| DAY | MORNING | AFTERNOON | DIM. | NOTES |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| Monday | | | | |
| Tuesday | | | | |
| Wednesday | | | | |
| Thursday | | | | |
| Friday | | | | |
| Saturday | | | | |
| Sunday | | | | |

**COACHING TIP**

► End this session with a writing activity, not a conversation. Give each resident a blank card and an envelope and ask them to write one line to someone — a grandchild, an old friend, a neighbor. It doesn't need to be long. The physical act of holding a pen and writing a message activates a different kind of memory and purpose than talking does.

Highlight moment this week: _____

# Week 13: What I Know for Sure

Community: _____ Week of: _____

Spiritual · National Radio Day

| DAY | MORNING | AFTERNOON | DIM. | NOTES |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| Monday | | | | |
| Tuesday | | | | |
| Wednesday | | | | |
| Thursday | | | | |
| Friday | | | | |
| Saturday | | | | |
| Sunday | | | | |

**COACHING TIP**

► This is the final session of the quarter. Slow down, sit closer, and treat it like a closing ceremony, not a regular activity. Begin by saying: "This week isn't about remembering the past. It's about what the past made you." Let residents speak for as long as they want. This session earns the quiet.

Highlight moment this week: _____


Activity
Planning

# Weekly Theme Details

## WEEK 1 Red, White, and Blue Memories

Social

Before the holiday became about backyard grills and department store sales, it was about the block party, the volunteer fire department parade, and the neighbor who rigged his entire porch with Roman candles. This week, invite your residents back to the Fourth of July they lived — the one that smelled like sparklers and tasted like watermelon on a paper plate.

### CONVERSATION STARTERS

- "Did your town have a Fourth of July parade? What was the best float or display you ever saw in it?"
- "Who in your neighborhood was in charge of the fireworks — and did anyone ever have a close call?"
- "What was the one dish that always showed up at your family's Fourth of July table, no matter what?"
- "Did you ever go to a community band concert or outdoor dance on the holiday? What do you remember about the music?"
- "What did a sparkler feel like in your hand when you were a kid — and were you the type to wave it around or hold it perfectly still?"

**Dimensions:** This theme covers: **Social** (shared community memories), **Cognitive** (recall of events and traditions), **Sensory** (sounds, smells, tastes of summer holidays).
To add **Physical**: lead a simple seated parade — hand out small flags and play a march while residents wave in rhythm.

*The Nostalgia Kit — Conversation Cards, Set 1; BINGO, Americana edition*

## WEEK 2 Summer Sounds

Sensory

Summer had a soundtrack that had nothing to do with the radio. Screen doors slamming. Sprinklers hitting the sidewalk. The jingle of the ice cream truck three streets over. Cicadas at dusk that were so loud you had to raise your voice on the porch. This week, listen for the sounds your residents still carry with them.

### CONVERSATION STARTERS

- "Did your neighborhood have an ice cream truck? Could you hear it coming from blocks away, and what did you run out to buy?"
- "What did your summer evenings sound like — crickets, a baseball game on the radio, neighbors talking across the fence?"
- "Did anyone in your house have a window fan or a box fan? What was it like trying to sleep with that hum going all night?"
- "Was there a sound that told you summer was officially here — the first lawn mower, the pool whistle, the school bell ringing for the last time?"
- "Did you ever sleep on a screened-in porch or with the windows wide open? What sounds drifted in?"

**Dimensions:** This theme covers: **Sensory** (auditory memory as the primary anchor), **Cognitive** (identifying and recalling specific sounds), **Social** (shared listening and storytelling).
To add **Creative**: ask residents to list every summer sound they can remember in two minutes — turn it into a collaborative "Summer Soundtrack" poster.

*The Nostalgia Kit — Musical Memory section; Visual Spark Cards, summer imagery*

# Weekly Theme Details

## WEEK 3 Kitchen Table Memories

Cognitive

The kitchen table was the original social network. Homework happened there. Bills got paid there. Sunday dinners ran long because nobody wanted to leave. It was where the family argued, laughed, and passed the bread. This week, pull up a chair and ask your residents to tell you what happened at theirs.

### CONVERSATION STARTERS

- "What was always sitting on your kitchen table — a salt shaker, a lazy Susan, a stack of mail, a bowl of fruit that nobody touched?"
- "Who sat where? Was there an unspoken seating chart, and what happened if someone sat in the wrong seat?"
- "What was the one rule at your family's table that every kid knew better than to break?"
- "Did your kitchen have a radio or a TV going during meals, or was it strictly conversation? What do you remember hearing?"
- "If you close your eyes and think about that kitchen, what do you smell first — coffee, bacon, something baking, dish soap?"

**Dimensions:** This theme covers: **Cognitive** (detailed recall and sequencing of routines), **Social** (family dynamics and mealtime rituals), **Sensory** (smells, textures, and sounds of the kitchen).
To add **Physical**: bring in a simple cooking activity — stir together a no-bake recipe while the conversation happens.

*The Kitchen Table Kit — Full kit; Conversation Cards, Sets 1–3; Visual Spark Cards*

## WEEK 4 The Great Outdoors

Physical

Before organized sports leagues and supervised play dates, summer meant being told to go outside and not come back until dinner. Kids built forts, caught lightning bugs, climbed trees they probably shouldn't have, and drank from the garden hose without a second thought. This week, take your residents back outside — even if only in memory.

### CONVERSATION STARTERS

- "What was the first thing you did when you got outside on a summer morning — before anyone told you to do anything?"
- "Did you have a swimming hole, a creek, a community pool, or a sprinkler? What was your go-to way to cool off?"
- "Were you a tree climber? Was there one particular tree that was yours, and how high did you dare to go?"
- "Did you ever catch fireflies in a jar? What did you do with them at the end of the night?"
- "What smell takes you straight back to being outside as a kid — fresh-cut grass, a charcoal grill, rain on hot pavement, the lake?"

**Dimensions:** This theme covers: **Physical** (movement memories, outdoor play), **Sensory** (smells and textures of the outdoors), **Cognitive** (sequencing childhood routines).
To add **Creative**: invite residents to draw or describe the yard, street, or field where they spent the most time as a child.

*The Everyday Life Kit — Conversation Cards, Set 2; Visual Spark Cards, neighborhood imagery*

# Weekly Theme Details

## WEEK 5 County Fair Classics

Social

The county fair was the biggest event of the summer in a lot of towns. The Ferris wheel you could see from the highway. The livestock barn that smelled like straw and something else entirely. The midway barker who swore you could win a stuffed bear for just one more quarter. This week, bring the fairgrounds to your activity room.

### CONVERSATION STARTERS

- "What was the first thing you headed for when you walked through the fair gates — the rides, the food, the animal barns, or the games?"
- "What was your go-to fair food — cotton candy, a candy apple, a corn dog, funnel cake, or something your fair was famous for?"
- "Did you ever enter anything in the county fair — a pie, a quilt, a canned good, a 4-H animal? Did you win?"
- "Were you brave enough for the Tilt-A-Whirl or the Scrambler, or did you prefer to keep your feet on the ground and watch other people scream?"
- "Did the fair have a grandstand show — a demolition derby, a tractor pull, a country singer? Who was the biggest act you ever saw there?"

**Dimensions:** This theme covers: **Social** (community events, group experiences), **Sensory** (food, smells, sounds of the midway), **Cognitive** (recall of specific events and competitions).
To add **Spiritual**: ask, "Was there something about the fair that felt like it brought the whole town together? What was that feeling like?"

*The Everyday Life Kit — Conversation Cards, Set 4; BINGO, Community Traditions edition*

## WEEK 6 The Sunday Drive

Cognitive

There was a time when getting in the car on a Sunday afternoon had no destination. You just drove. Past the new construction on Route 9. Through the countryside to see if the corn was high yet. To the next town over for no reason at all. The Sunday drive was how families spent time together before anyone invented the phrase "quality time."

### CONVERSATION STARTERS

- "Did your family take Sunday drives? Who drove, and did they have a usual route or did they just wander?"
- "What did the backseat look like on a family drive — were you squeezed in with siblings, or did you have a window to yourself?"
- "Did your family ever stop for ice cream, a roadside stand, or a scenic overlook during a drive? Was there a regular spot?"
- "What was the car like — bench seats, no air conditioning, windows rolled down? Do you remember the color or the make?"
- "Was there a road or a drive your family took so often that you could describe every house, barn, and bend from memory?"

**Dimensions:** This theme covers: **Cognitive** (route memory, spatial recall, sequencing), **Social** (family togetherness, shared rituals), **Sensory** (the feel and sounds of the car, roadside smells).
To add **Creative**: invite residents to sketch a map of their family's most familiar Sunday drive route, labeling the landmarks they remember.

*The Road Trip Kit — Conversation Cards, Set 1; Trivia, Highways & Byways edition*

# Weekly Theme Details

## WEEK 7 Main Street Memories

Creative

Before the interstate bypass and the shopping mall, every town had a Main Street. The five-and-dime where everything really cost a nickel or a dime. The barber who knew your father's name. The drugstore lunch counter where a grilled cheese and a cherry Coke were the height of luxury. This week, walk your residents down the street they never really left.

### CONVERSATION STARTERS

- "What was the first store you walked into when your family went downtown — and what did it smell like the moment you opened the door?"
- "Did your Main Street have a soda fountain or a lunch counter? What did you order, and did you sit at the counter or in a booth?"
- "Was there a shopkeeper who knew every family in town by name? What was that relationship like — did they extend credit, save things for you, or just know your usual?"
- "What store window stopped you in your tracks every time you walked by? Was it the toy store, the dress shop, the hardware display, or something else?"
- "If you could walk down that Main Street one more time exactly as it was, which block would you start on and where would you end up?"

**Dimensions:** This theme covers: **Creative** (drawing and mapping from memory), **Cognitive** (spatial recall, sequencing of locations), **Social** (shared hometown stories).
To add **Sensory**: bring in scents associated with old shops — leather, peppermint, sawdust, or fresh-baked bread — and ask which store each scent reminds them of.

*The Everyday Life Kit — Conversation Cards, Set 3; Trivia, Hometown edition*

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## WEEK 8 Porches, Stoops, and Screen Doors

Sensory

The front porch was where the day wound down. The creak of a rocking chair. The smell of citronella. A neighbor waving from across the street. The screen door that announced every arrival and departure with a particular slam that no one ever fixed. This week, sit on the porch with your residents and let the evening come.

### CONVERSATION STARTERS

- "Did your family spend time on the front porch, the back stoop, or both? What was the difference between the two?"
- "What sounds did you hear sitting outside on a summer evening — sprinklers, kids playing, someone's radio, the distant rumble of a train?"
- "Did your screen door have a particular sound when it closed — a slap, a wheeze, a slow hiss? Could you tell who was coming or going just by the way they let it shut?"
- "Was there a neighbor you could always count on seeing outside in the evening? Did you wave, walk over, or just nod and keep rocking?"
- "What did your family drink on the porch — lemonade, iced tea, a cold beer, or something your mother made from a recipe nobody wrote down?"

**Dimensions:** This theme covers: **Sensory** (sounds, smells, textures of outdoor evening life), **Social** (neighbor interactions, family togetherness), **Cognitive** (recall of routines and settings).
To add **Physical**: set up rocking chairs or gliders if available and hold the session outside or near a window with a breeze.

*The Everyday Life Kit — Conversation Cards, Set 1; Visual Spark Cards, neighborhood imagery*

# Weekly Theme Details

## WEEK 9 Songs That Changed Everything

Spiritual

There are songs that don't just remind you of a time — they take you there. The first slow dance. The car radio on the night everything changed. The hymn at a wedding or a funeral that you can still feel in your chest. This week, go beyond favorite songs and ask about the ones that mattered.

### CONVERSATION STARTERS

- "Is there a song that, the moment you hear the first three notes, puts you back in a specific room, at a specific age, with a specific person?"
- "What was the first song you ever danced to with someone who made your heart race? Do you remember where you were standing?"
- "Was there a song your family played at every gathering — a wedding song, a holiday song, a song that meant 'our family' to everyone who heard it?"
- "Did a song ever help you through a hard time — not because the lyrics were cheerful, but because it made you feel understood?"
- "If you had to choose one song to represent the best chapter of your life, what would it be — and what chapter does it belong to?"

**Dimensions:** This theme covers: **Spiritual** (meaning, purpose, life reflection through music), **Sensory** (auditory and emotional response), **Social** (shared musical memories and storytelling).
To add **Cognitive**: after the conversation, play short clips and ask residents to name the artist and the year — a gentle trivia element that rewards deep cultural memory.

*The Nostalgia Kit — Musical Memory section; Conversation Cards, Set 2*

## WEEK 10 The Schoolhouse

Cognitive

The schoolhouse shaped more than your education. It gave you your first best friend, your first real embarrassment, and the teacher whose voice you can still hear saying your name. It smelled like chalk dust and floor wax and whatever the cafeteria was cooking that day. This week, send your residents back to class.

### CONVERSATION STARTERS

- "What did your school look like from the outside — was it brick, wood, one room, or a big building? How did you get there each morning?"
- "Was there a teacher who changed the way you saw the world — not necessarily your favorite, but the one who expected the most from you?"
- "What was in your lunchbox or lunch bag, and did you ever trade with someone who had something better?"
- "What did recess look like at your school? Were you the kid on the swings, the one playing kickball, or the one sitting under a tree with a book?"
- "Can you still remember any rules that were posted on the classroom wall or any punishment for breaking them?"

**Dimensions:** This theme covers: **Cognitive** (detailed recall of settings, routines, and people), **Social** (school friendships and teacher relationships), **Sensory** (smells of chalk, cafeteria, schoolyard).
To add **Creative**: ask residents to write one sentence on a card about the most important thing school taught them — not a subject, but a life lesson. Share anonymously.

*The Everyday Life Kit — Conversation Cards, Set 1; Trivia, School Days edition*

# Weekly Theme Details

## WEEK 11 Handy Work

Physical

There was a time when fixing something wasn't a phone call — it was a Saturday. Patching a screen. Hanging a shelf. Hemming a dress. Changing the oil in the driveway. People took pride in knowing how things worked and being able to make them right again with their own two hands. This week, honor the skills your residents built over a lifetime.

### CONVERSATION STARTERS

- "What was one thing you could fix or build that made you proud — something other people called you to help with?"
- "Who taught you to work with your hands — a parent, a grandparent, a shop teacher, or did you figure it out by watching and trying?"
- "Did you have a workbench, a sewing corner, a toolbox, or a junk drawer that had everything you needed? What was always in it?"
- "What's a skill you had that most people today wouldn't know how to do — canning, upholstering, sharpening a blade, darning a sock?"
- "Was there a project that went completely wrong — something you started with confidence that ended with a phone call to someone who actually knew what they were doing?"

**Dimensions:** This theme covers: **Physical** (motor memory, hands-on skills, body knowledge), **Cognitive** (procedural recall and problem-solving), **Social** (mentorship stories, community self-reliance).
To add **Spiritual**: ask, "Is there something about making or fixing things with your own hands that gave you a sense of peace or purpose?"

*The Everyday Life Kit — Conversation Cards, Set 2; Visual Spark Cards, tools and trades imagery*

## WEEK 12 Letters, Cards, and the Mailbox

Creative

The mailbox used to matter. Not bills and junk mail — real letters. A note from a friend in another state. A birthday card with a five-dollar bill folded inside. A love letter with a return address you checked for every afternoon. The ritual of writing, sending, and waiting was its own kind of connection. This week, open the mailbox again.

### CONVERSATION STARTERS

- "Did you ever have a pen pal or someone you wrote to regularly? What did you look forward to most about getting their letters?"
- "Was there a particular kind of stationery or card you always used — a brand, a color, a pattern — something people recognized as yours?"
- "What was the best piece of mail you ever received — the one you might have kept in a drawer for years?"
- "Did your family have a holiday card tradition? Did your mother write a letter inside, or was it strictly 'With love, The Johnsons'?"
- "What was it like to walk to the mailbox and find something with your name on it — not a bill, not an ad, but something someone sat down and wrote just for you?"

**Dimensions:** This theme covers: **Creative** (letter writing, self-expression through correspondence), **Cognitive** (recall of relationships and communication rituals), **Social** (pen pal and family letter traditions).
To add **Sensory**: bring in different textured stationery and envelopes and let residents feel the paper — ask if it reminds them of the kind their family used.

*The Everyday Life Kit — Conversation Cards, Set 4; Visual Spark Cards, mail and correspondence imagery*

# Weekly Theme Details

## WEEK 13 What I Know for Sure

Spiritual

A life fully lived leaves you with things you know that no textbook can teach. Not facts — truths. The kind of knowing that comes from raising children, surviving loss, building something from nothing, and learning when to speak and when to let it go. This week, honor your residents as the experts they are and ask them to share what a lifetime of living has made clear.

### CONVERSATION STARTERS

- "What is one piece of advice you would give to a young person starting out today — something you wish someone had told you at twenty?"
- "Is there something you believe now that you absolutely did not believe when you were younger? What changed your mind?"
- "What is one skill or habit that has served you well your entire life — something simple that people overlook?"
- "Was there a moment in your life when you realized you were stronger than you thought? What happened?"
- "If you could sit across from your younger self for five minutes, what would you say — and do you think they would listen?"

**Dimensions:** This theme covers: **Spiritual** (meaning, wisdom, legacy, inner life), **Cognitive** (synthesis of life experience into principles), **Social** (intergenerational mentorship and group reflection).
To add **Creative**: ask each resident to dictate or write one sentence that begins with "I know for sure that…" and compile them into a single-page document to share with families.

*The Nostalgia Kit — Conversation Cards, Set 3; Musical Memory, legacy songs edition*


1960s
Nostalgic Conversations
1980s
Nostalgic Conversations
TRIVIA/BINGO

# Resource Integration Guide

How each weekly theme connects to Comfort Bond™ kits — and what to do without them.

This guide shows you which Comfort Bond™ engagement resources align with each week's theme. You don't need any of these kits to use the Blueprint. But if you're looking for ready-made, adult-centered content that saves you hours of preparation, this is where to start.

| WK | THEME | KIT CONNECTION | ALTERNATIVE (NO KIT) |
|---|---|---|---|
| 1 | Red, White, and Blue Memories | The Nostalgia Kit — Conversation Cards, Set 1; BINGO, Americana edition | Play a recording of "Stars and Stripes Forever" and ask the room to raise a hand when they hear the part that makes them think of a parade they attended. |
| 2 | Summer Sounds | The Nostalgia Kit — Musical Memory section; Visual Spark Cards, summer imagery | Play five short sound clips (screen door, sprinkler, cicadas, lawn mower, thunderstorm) and ask residents to name each one and share a memory it triggers. |
| 3 | Kitchen Table Memories | The Kitchen Table Kit — Full kit; Conversation Cards, Sets 1–3; Visual Spark Cards | Place a vintage kitchen utensil (a hand-crank egg beater, a cast-iron trivet, a flour sifter) on the table and ask: "Who remembers what this was for, and who used it in your house?" |
| 4 | The Great Outdoors | The Everyday Life Kit — Conversation Cards, Set 2; Visual Spark Cards, neighborhood imagery | Bring a sprig of fresh rosemary, a handful of grass clippings, or a small jar of dirt and pass them around — ask each resident what outdoor memory the smell brings back. |
| 5 | County Fair Classics | The Everyday Life Kit — Conversation Cards, Set 4; BINGO, Community Traditions edition | Set up a simple "fair food vote" on a whiteboard — list five classic fair foods and let residents place a tally mark next to their favorite, then discuss the winner. |

| WK | THEME | KIT CONNECTION | ALTERNATIVE (NO KIT) |
|---|---|---|---|
| 6 | The Sunday Drive | The Road Trip Kit — Conversation Cards, Set 1; Trivia, Highways & Byways edition | Show a photo of a 1950s or 1960s car dashboard and ask residents to identify each knob, dial, and feature — then ask who in their family owned a car like that. |
| 7 | Main Street Memories | The Everyday Life Kit — Conversation Cards, Set 3; Trivia, Hometown edition | Print a vintage black-and-white photo of a 1950s Main Street and ask residents to name every store they can identify from the signage and window displays. |
| 8 | Porches, Stoops, and Screen Doors | The Everyday Life Kit — Conversation Cards, Set 1; Visual Spark Cards, neighborhood imagery | Play a two-minute recording of evening nature sounds — crickets, a screen door, distant laughter — and ask residents to close their eyes and describe what porch or stoop the sounds take them back to. |
| 9 | Songs That Changed Everything | The Nostalgia Kit — Musical Memory section; Conversation Cards, Set 2 | Ask each resident to name one song and briefly say why it mattered, then compile the list on a whiteboard as a collaborative “Playlist of Our Lives.” |

| WK | THEME | KIT CONNECTION | ALTERNATIVE (NO KIT) |
|---|---|---|---|
| 10 | The Schoolhouse | The Everyday Life Kit — Conversation Cards, Set 1; Trivia, School Days edition | Bring in a piece of chalk and an old-fashioned slate (or a small chalkboard) and ask residents to write their name the way they did in grade school — then share the memory of learning penmanship. |
| 11 | Handy Work | The Everyday Life Kit — Conversation Cards, Set 2; Visual Spark Cards, tools and trades imagery | Set out five common hand tools (a tape measure, a Phillips screwdriver, a pair of pliers, a hammer, a hand saw) and ask residents to pick up the one they used most in their life — then tell the group why. |
| 12 | Letters, Cards, and the Mailbox | The Everyday Life Kit — Conversation Cards, Set 4; Visual Spark Cards, mail and correspondence imagery | Give each resident a pre-stamped postcard and help them write a short note to a family member or friend — then actually mail them. |
| 13 | What I Know for Sure | The Nostalgia Kit — Conversation Cards, Set 3; Musical Memory, legacy songs edition | Give each resident a card with the prompt "I know for sure that…" printed at the top, ask them to complete it, and display the cards anonymously on a bulletin board for families to read. |

# Planning Notes & Ideas

*Supply lists, activity variations, resident preferences, family follow-ups, ideas for next quarter…*

COMING NEXT

# Quarter 4 · October – December 2026

Harvest memories, holiday traditions, winter kitchens, and end-of-year reflections. Thirteen new themes, coaching tips, and resource connections — delivered before you need them.

Your next edition arrives by August 30, 2026.



*Your residents deserve more than random activities. They deserve a system.*

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